- Lay the fusible interfacing on your ironing board (or ironing surface) with the fusible side up, the paper side or parchment paper on the ironing board side so that the fusible web does not fuse to the ironing board cover.
- Lay the pattern, right side up, on the interfacing, so that the interfacing will be fused to the wrong side of the paper pattern pieces.
- Place the pieces close together to prevent wasting the interfacing but do not overlap the pattern pieces. (Ignore laying the pattern out following the grain lines for preserving the pattern).
- Lay parchment paper on top of the pattern pieces and press the pieces to the interfacing, keeping everything flat and smooth.
- Cut out the pattern pieces, after the pieces are firmly fused together. Consider putting all the pieces in a large brown mailing envelope with the pattern envelope taped securely to the front and back of the brown envelope. Clear packing tape over the pattern envelope. Preserve the original envelope on the brown envelope.

8.17 Pattern Alteration

A comfortable, attractive garment fits properly. It is neither too large nor too small and conforms to the contours of the body without binding, pulling, sagging, straining or wrinkling. Fitting problems usually involve one or more of these basic body areas: neckline, bust line, hipline, arms, shoulder line, back waistline or abdomen.

Pattern adjustments and alterations are often necessary to achieve a good fit, especially in a form-fitting garment. Making adjustments or alterations before the garment is cut from the fabric will eliminate many problems later.

A Pattern can be Altered and Adjusted in Three Ways

- By folding out excess fullness
- By slashing and spreading or overlapping along pattern lines to increase or decrease dimensions.
- By redrawing darts or seam lines.

8.17.1 Standards for Pattern Alteration

Pattern Alteration Standards

- Original grain-lines are saved
- Patterns are kept in balance and proportion
- Change is created only in required point needed and is not obvious
- Designer's lines are protected

8.17.2 Basic Rules or Techniques of Pattern Alteration

- All similar pieces must be altered to correspond with the alterations on the major piece
- Additions or extensions must be made by taping an extension strip to the edge involved
- Altered patterns must have the same character as the original pattern piece
- Correct movement on altered pattern to give the altered line the same character as the original line
- The altered pattern must be properly flat, as like the original pattern piece

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